

The Anunnaki Nuclear War — And the Archaeological Evidence Nobody Will Discuss

Transcribed by [TurboScribe](#). [Go Unlimited](#) to remove this message.

I wasn't looking for evidence of a nuclear war when I found this. I want to be clear about that from the start, because the direction this research went was not where I expected it to go, and I think that matters for how you receive what I'm about to lay out. I was reading the oldest written lament in human history, not a summary of it.

The actual text was translated by Samuel Noah Kramer, one of the most respected Sumerologists of the 20th century, and published by the Oriental Institute at the University of Chicago. The poem is called The Lamentation over the Destruction of Sumer and Ur. It dates to roughly 2000 BCE, and it describes, in extraordinary detail, the end of Sumerian civilization.

I expected it to describe a military conquest. That's how civilizations end in the ancient world, in most cases. Armies arrive, cities fall, populations are displaced or absorbed.

That's the standard narrative arc of Bronze Age collapse. That is not what the text describes. The text describes a wind.

Not a metaphorical wind. Not a wind as a poetic stand-in for an invading army, which is a literary device that does appear in ancient literature, and which I considered as an interpretation before reading further. This text is specific in ways that rule out metaphor.

The wind killed everything it touched. It turned the rivers bitter. It left bodies in the streets with no visible wounds, no signs of violence, no evidence of combat.

It made the land itself uninhabitable. And crucially, in a detail that I kept returning to because it does not fit any conventional military or natural disaster narrative, it drove away the gods. Not just the people.

The gods abandoned their cities before the wind arrived, as if they knew what was coming and chose to leave rather than face it. City after city, the text repeats the same structure. The god of the city departed.

Then the wind came. Then there was nothing. I read the academic commentary on this text.

The standard interpretation is that it is a theological response to political collapse. The Akkadian conquest of Sumer, dressed in mythological language. The wind is a literary device.

The departing gods represent the perceived withdrawal of divine favor that any ancient people would attribute to military defeat. That interpretation requires the text to be doing something very specific with its language. It requires the descriptions of a wind that leaves bodies without wounds.

That turns rivers bitter. That makes land uninhabitable for years to be figurative rather than descriptive. It requires a poet recording what was understood to be a literal catastrophe to be speaking entirely in metaphor while describing physical, observable consequences.

I found that explanation increasingly difficult to accept the more carefully I read the text. Not because I came to it with a predetermined conclusion. Because the text does not read like metaphor.

It reads like testimony. And then I found the geology. In 2021, a paper was published in Scientific Reports, a nature portfolio journal.

It was peer-reviewed and co-authored by researchers from 17 institutions, including the University of California, Santa Barbara, Comet Research Group, and DePaul University. The lead author was Christopher R. Bunch. The paper's title is Tunguska Scale Airburst Destroyed Tall El Hammam, a Middle Bronze Age city in the Jordan Valley near the Dead Sea.

I want to stay with what that paper actually documents before discussing what it means. Because the physical evidence is the foundation of everything that follows. And it deserves to be treated with precision.

Tall El Hammam is an archaeological site in the southern Jordan Valley. It was a significant Bronze Age city, one of the largest in the region during the Middle Bronze Age. Based on the stratigraphy and the dating of the destruction layer, the site was abruptly abandoned around 1650 BCE, though some estimates place the catastrophic event closer to 1700 BCE.

Either date falls within the same general period as the collapse of Sumerian urban civilization. What the excavation found in the destruction layer is not consistent with military conquest, fire, earthquake, or any conventional ancient disaster. The pottery across the site had been vitrified, turned to glass.

Not melted in the way that kiln-fired pottery would show heat damage. Instead, it was transformed rapidly and completely into a glassy material that requires temperatures of approximately 1,500 degrees Celsius or higher. Standard fires, even catastrophic urban fires, do not approach those temperatures.

The mud brick across the site had been melted and then re-solidified. The surface of the destruction layer contained shocked quartz, a form of quartz that only results from extreme pressure events found in nuclear test sites and meteor impact craters. The layer also contained platinum group metals and nanodiamonds.

Both are markers associated with cosmic impact events and high-energy airbursts. The researchers concluded that a cosmic airburst, similar in mechanism to the 1908 Tunguska event in Siberia, but significantly larger in destructive yield, had occurred directly over or near Tall el-Hammam. The thermal pulse from the airburst would have been sufficient to instantaneously ignite every combustible material across a wide area.

It could vitrify pottery, melt mud brick, and kill every living thing in the affected zone through a combination of the thermal event and the pressure wave. The paper describes secondary effects, including the vaporization and dispersal of salt from the Dead Sea Basin across the surrounding agricultural land, vaporized salt, carried on a wind, making the land uninhabitable for agriculture for years or decades. I stopped reading and went back to the lamentation text.

The wind that killed everything it touched. The rivers turned bitter. The land was made uninhabitable.

The bodies had no visible wounds. A thermal pulse and a pressure wave from an airburst would kill exposed individuals without leaving the marks of conventional violence. There was the sudden, total abandonment of multiple cities across a region with no evidence of the gradual depopulation that accompanies famine, plague, or military defeat.

The 2021 paper does not mention the lamentation over the destruction of Sumer and Ur. It does not reference Sumerian mythology. It is a geological and archaeological paper focused on the physical evidence at one site in the Jordan Valley.

Its authors were not looking for a connection to ancient texts, and they did not claim one. But the physical description of what happened at Tal el-Hammam, including an airburst, a thermal event, salt dispersal, sudden, total destruction, and land rendered uninhabitable, and the textual description in the oldest written lament in human history of an evil wind that destroyed Sumerian civilization without visible wounds, turned the land bitter, and drove away gods and people overnight, are not separate phenomena requiring separate explanations. They are, at minimum, descriptions of events with identical physical characteristics, occurring in the same region in the same general historical period.

Nobody has officially connected them. I want to address Sitchin directly, because if you have spent any time in the alternative history space, you know that the nuclear war interpretation of the Sumerian collapse is primarily associated with his work, and I think the association has done genuine damage to the conversation. Sitchin argued that the Anunnaki, in his reading extraterrestrial beings who came to earth from a planet called Nibiru, detonated nuclear weapons in Mesopotamia around 2000 BCE, and that the lamentation text and several related cuneiform documents describe the aftermath of that detonation.

He cited the same lament texts I have been discussing, along with the era epic and other Akkadian period documents that describe strange destructive events. The nuclear war interpretation is what most people know. It is also what most people dismiss, because Sitchin's methodology was contested, and because the extraterrestrial framing puts the entire line of inquiry into a category that mainstream scholarship does not engage with.

But here is what I think gets lost in that dismissal. The physical anomaly, the one that doesn't require Sitchin, the one that doesn't require ancient astronauts, the one that exists in peer-reviewed geology published in a Nature Portfolio Journal in 2021, that anomaly is real. The

vitrified pottery is real.

The shocked quartz is real. The platinum group, metals, and nanodiamonds are real. The salt dispersal pattern is real.

The destruction layer at Tal el-Hammam is real, and what it contains is not explained by any conventional Bronze Age event. The question of what caused it does not require a predetermined answer. A cosmic airburst is the conclusion the paper's authors reached from the physical evidence, and it is a scientifically defensible conclusion.

What the paper's authors did not address, because it was not within the scope of their study, is the connection between the geological evidence and the ancient textual record. The question is whether a cosmic airburst over the Jordan Valley in the Middle Bronze Age, an event that would have been witnessed across a wide area, that would have produced exactly the phenomenology described in the Sumerian Lamentation, over the destruction of Sumer and Ur, and that would have been experienced by surviving populations, as a wind that killed without visible wounds and made the land uninhabitable, might be the event that ancient Mesopotamian scribes were describing when they wrote about the evil wind. That connection has not been made in the academic literature.

The paper published in 2021 has been cited in subsequent geological and archaeological work. Its findings have not been seriously disputed. The physical evidence is robust.

The implications of those findings for our understanding of Bronze Age Mesopotamian history, and specifically for our interpretation of the Sumerian Lament tradition, have not been explored. Why not? I have been thinking about this question for a long time. The most charitable answer is disciplinary siloing.

The geologists and impact researchers who produced the Tal el-Hammam paper are not Sumerologists, and the Sumerologists working on Lament texts are not reading papers in scientific reports about cosmic airbursts. Academic disciplines do not always talk to each other, and the connection I am describing requires someone to be reading across both literatures simultaneously. That is a real phenomenon, and I do not want to dismiss it as an explanation.

Academic research is specialized by necessity, and the failure to connect two datasets that exist in different disciplinary contexts is often genuine incuriosity, rather than deliberate suppression. But I find it harder to apply that explanation to the media coverage. The paper from 2021 was covered briefly by a number of science and mainstream news outlets.

The coverage focused on the Sodom Connection, Tal el-Hammam's identification by some researchers as the biblical city of Sodom, and the cosmic airburst as a possible natural explanation for the destruction described in Genesis. That angle was treated as interesting briefly, and then the coverage ended. The Sumerian Connection, the fact that the lamentation over the destruction of Sumer and Ur, the oldest written lament in human history, describes an

event with the same physical characteristics as what the geology documents at Tal el-Hammam, in the same region, in the same historical period, was not part of the coverage.

It was not explored. It was not mentioned. Now I want to bring in one more layer, because the Tal el-Hammam paper is not the only geological anomaly associated with this period and region.

The Era Epic is an Akkadian text, roughly contemporaneous with the late Sumerian period, that describes the god Era, a deity associated with plague and war, conducting a campaign of destruction across multiple cities. The language of the Era Epic has long been noted by scholars for its unusual specificity. It does not describe battle.

It describes sudden, total destruction. Cities emptied, populations vanished. The destruction attributed to Era is not the destruction of military conquest.

It is categorical annihilation, the kind where nothing remains and nothing returns. Read alongside the lamentation text and alongside the geological evidence from Tal el-Hammam, the Era Epic starts to look less like mythology and more like a regional account of a catastrophe that multiple scribal traditions in different cities were independently attempting to record and make sense of. What happened in the Jordan Valley in the Middle Bronze Age left a physical signature in the ground that a peer-reviewed paper in 2021 described in terms of temperatures exceeding the surface of the sun, instantaneous vitrification of pottery, and the dispersal of salt across agricultural land.

It happened. The evidence is in the stratigraphy. Something caused it.

The paper's authors concluded it was a cosmic air burst. That conclusion is scientifically defensible and has not been seriously challenged. The people who lived in the region at the time experienced it as a wind that killed without wounds, turned the land bitter, drove away gods and people, and ended the civilization they had built over thousands of years.

They wrote about it in the most detailed and emotionally raw text that has survived from the ancient world. They called it the evil wind. They spent the rest of their cultural existence trying to understand why it happened and whether the gods could be persuaded to prevent it from happening again.

We have their testimony. We have the geology. We have a peer-reviewed paper connecting the physical evidence to an extreme cosmic event.

What we do not have is the conversation between those two datasets that the evidence seems to demand. The lamentation text is in the Oriental Institute in Chicago. The tall El Hammam paper is publicly available in Scientific Reports.

The physical connection between what the geology documents and what the Sumerians described is not a fringe claim or an alternative history interpretation. It is a straightforward

observation about two bodies of evidence that describe the same physical phenomena in the same place at the same time. Someone needs to sit down with both of them and ask the question that neither dataset alone can answer.

What happened in the Jordan Valley around 1700 BC that was catastrophic enough to end a civilization, leave glass in the soil, and produce the oldest written expression of grief in human history? The evidence is there. The question is open. And the conversation, for reasons I find increasingly difficult to explain as innocent disciplinary oversight, has not happened.

Transcribed by [TurboScribe](#). [Go Unlimited](#) to remove this message.